# Ashter Aown Ali

Software Engineer | Applied AI & NLP

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## PROFILE

Software engineer with 4+ years of experience building production web systems (MERN, Laravel) and, currently, AI-assisted chatbot and calling-automation features for sales workflows. Self-directed work in NLP and document question answering. Seeking a research-oriented Master's in Computer Science / AI to work on NLP, LLMs and intelligent software systems.

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Natural Language Processing • Document Question Answering • Information Retrieval • Large Language Models • Retrieval-Augmented Generation • AI for Software Engineering

## EDUCATION

**B.S. in Software Engineering** 2021 – 2025

*Sindh Madressatul Islam University, Karachi, Pakistan*

Relevant coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Database Systems, Artificial Intelligence, Software Engineering, Web Technologies

**Intermediate in Computer Science** 2018 – 2020

*Akhuwat College, Lahore, Pakistan*

## PROJECTS

**Student Research Assistant – Multi-Document Question Answering** HTML/JS, PDF parsing

- Prototype that parses multiple uploaded research papers, answers questions grounded in the source text, and compares papers across a set.

**Text Summarizer – NLP Web App** Python, NLP

- Tool that condenses long documents into short summaries, built and tested on real text rather than toy datasets.

**AI Skill Mirror** Python, Laravel, Blade

- Full-stack app that evaluates a user's skills and generates a career profile with role recommendations (rules-based evaluation layer).

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**AI & Full Stack Developer – Gritix Digital, Karachi** Mar 2024 – Present

- Developing CRM/ERP features and an AI-assisted chatbot and calling-automation tool for sales workflows.
- Led migration of a legacy PHP monolith to Laravel, improving scalability and API performance.
- Built a multi-vendor e-commerce platform with automated orders, real-time inventory and payment gateways (Stripe, JazzCash).
- Developed admin dashboards with data visualization, reducing manual reporting effort.

**AI & Full Stack Developer (Remote) – Orbit Walls, Dubai** Jan 2025 – Present

- Built a Web3 crypto payment wallet app that connects external wallets (Trust Wallet, Binance Wallet) for crypto payments.
- Designed REST APIs for user accounts, transaction records and payment-status tracking.

**Web Developer – Aim Digital, Karachi** Jan 2023 – Nov 2023

- Built a React/Node.js CRM for client lead management and conversion tracking.
- Upgraded a legacy PHP system to Laravel with stronger security and optimized database queries.
- Contributed to an e-commerce platform with inventory management, a recommendation engine and secure checkout.

**Programming Instructor (C++ & C#) – Freelance**

- Teach OOP, data structures and algorithms to beginner and intermediate students through project-based curricula.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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|---|---|
| **AI / NLP** | Python, NLP, LLMs, Generative AI, RAG, Document QA, Information Retrieval, Conversational AI, Applied ML |
| **Languages** | Python, JavaScript (ES6+), PHP, Java, C++, C#, SQL |
| **Web & Tools** | React.js, Node.js, Express.js, Laravel, REST APIs, Git/GitHub |
| **Databases** | MySQL, MongoDB, Firebase |

## INDEPENDENT STUDY

Self-directed study (not formal research training) in Machine Learning and Deep Learning, NLP and LLMs, Generative AI, Computer Vision, and cloud AI platforms (AWS, Azure).

## CERTIFICATIONS

- Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning Fundamentals – SMIT, 2023
- Front End Development (Professional) – Aptech Institute, 2022
- MERN Stack Development; Advanced Java Programming – Smart Programming India, 2021

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Contributed to 100+ client websites and enterprise applications (ERP, CRM, HRM, e-commerce, chatbots).
- GitHub: 70+ public repositories, including the projects above. Active on LeetCode and HackerRank.
- Languages: English, Urdu.